

The NEW and IMPROVED
2015
CASH FLOW
CALENDAR

**Over 1,584 Marketing Ideas That Attracts New
Clients and Puts Cash in Your Pocket!**

8th Edition



INSTRUCTIONS

by Troy White... Turning Words Into Wealth

www.CashFlowCalendars.com

Welcome to your 2015 Marketing & Promotional Calendar!

When planning your marketing campaigns and promotions, make sure you choose ones that fit your industry, target market and goals but don't be afraid to go out-of-the-box.

This marketing and promotional calendar has **thousands of unique ideas** that you can change to grow your company. Use this calendar to maintain all your planned and actual promotional events.

Make sure you try to schedule events 3-6 months in advance to create an effective promotion.

To use this calendar efficiently, always **READ AHEAD!**

Look at the time it will take to write your promo, organize printing, envelope stuffing and mailing etc.

*For example, if you want to do a Valentines day promotion – make sure you have prepared your mailing materials and **have it printed AT LEAST 30 days before** the day you want it to hit everyone's mailbox. Mail it 7 – 10 business days before your offer begins. If you are mailing across the Canada/US border – leave at least 14 business days.*

*It may take less time and get there early, but that is better than the package showing up **AFTER THE DEADLINE!***

Not that it has ever happened to me – ah hem.

Ok maybe once.

Some extra hints:

- Don't forget to include local community events in your planning. For example, since I live in Calgary – I focused my attention on the Calgary Stampede and have since built a successful plan with my Wild West Wealth Summit. It tied into something and has since exploded into something else. Tie yourself into municipal events – national events – and ANYTHING media worthy that you can tie into your business or offering.
- If you can't seem to find a great promotion, consider declaring your own holiday event. You will find tons of different unusual celebrations throughout this calendar but don't forget to include your company's anniversary etc. The main thing to remember is to not let a marketing opportunity pass you by!
- Make sure you also track your marketing costs for each event and the results from it. By doing this – you will give yourself an easy glance at which events and promotion were productive. This will help you with your future marketing planning.
- **Outside of the envelope is key.** Live stamps (use multiples if possible, special edition stamps, crooked or upside down), blue ink, blind approach (with no company name, just your return address). Send by Fedex if you can. Phony Fedex envelopes. UPS style envelope. Placemats, brown paper bags. Get through the clutter! It must appear so important they have no choice but to open it. One of the nicest

things with Lumpy mail (which refers to the grabbers you insert with the mailer – many examples are in this calendar) is that it is next to IMPOSSIBLE to throw it out without opening it... the curiosity factor is immense.

- Once you open it – the inside must be congruent with the outside. Do not give them a “I’ve been conned” feeling. If it says Confidential and Personal – there had better be the same on the inside! Same with photo enclosed. Fragile.
- **Keep em reading!** Grabbers at top of letters. Personalization. Opening sentence after the headline - - not the place to talk about yourself. Talk about what it is going to do to help the reader. Use the If you..... then..... as an intro. Cosmetics of the letter and contents are key. Personalize it as much as you can. Gimmicky things. Grabbers, devices. You are trying to buy a few moments of permission from them.
- **Create urgency.** Big issue – most will attempt to set it aside. They typically will never buy if they do. Make it easy. Make it fast. Make it clear and very prominent that there is urgency. Choices of incentive and penalty. Multiple incentives. Choice of incentives. Discounts. Payment terms. Penalties. Take away bonuses. Take away portions of the product or service. Analogy – “be back” customers never do what they say. < 3% do. **Good reason for why an urgency must be created – because it takes work off your plate if it sells out quickly – and costs you less.**
- **Don’t be cheap... but control your costs!** Especially in small run mailers. Format – page size – heavier paper. Have a much tighter targeted mailer. Get rid of the names of people who don’t fit the perfect client profile.
- **Some exceptional places to get marketing ideas:** www.OrientalTrading.com (a great source of inexpensive “grabbers” for your mailings. Or www.PlumParty.com for a little higher end grabber (or bonus product). **Last, www.promoprofits.com GETS direct mail and has an exceptional program in place**

If you need help with getting started I recommend taking, The Sales Letter Success Workshop and Home Study Course! For a very minimal investment, you can learn exactly how to create sales letters that sell.

Visit: <http://saleslettersuccess.com/homestudy.html> to get more information about this program! My other clients have had great success with this course:

"A great handout package and resources kit - lots of unique and inspiring marketing techniques. You always deliver more than you promise! Thanks Troy." - Kim Palmer

"Huge volume of useful material. Great value Troy!" - Ann Stewart

I can craft you a sales letter to tie into your campaign. Warning though: I require 6 weeks in advance to complete a project like this - or a rush charge does apply. My minimum project fee for writing a campaign is now \$6,000. (I do not do one-off letters anymore; better results are attained by a consistent marketing system that keeps in touch with your customers on a regular basis). Consider it the wisest investment you can make in creating a sales system that will continue to make you money for many years to come. If that is out of your budget, let me know and I will refer some other writers to you.

Please put this into ACTION! It is the easiest way possible to grow your business by 130% OR MORE in the next 90 days or less.

Take everything that you now know about your business and industry... and find a way to recreate the way your clients buy from you and hear from you.

It will make a major difference in the types of clients that buy from you... and from the amount of money you make from the same amount of time being put into your business.

Last, remember the McGraw Hill study. I know you would much prefer growing your business by 256% over 19%... **and more effective marketing is the key.**

No matter what the economy is doing, more marketing will always improve your bottom line results... when it is done right.

Take the lessons in this and FIND WAYS to make them fit your own business.

They can easily add some serious dollars to your bank account... IF YOU USE THEM. They don't magically add millions to your pockets... YOU have to do something with them.

Once you do, and you start seeing results, reinvest the additional revenues right away into more marketing, bigger marketing, better marketing. You will easily come out of this recession an entirely new company with a serious surge of cash.

To your success,
Troy White
403-259-4566

24 Ways You Can Use The Cash Flow Calendar and Sales Letters or Emails Combined... To Attract More Clients and Improve Your Cash Flow

1. Eliminate the need for cold calls – the letters do the work for you
2. Get referrals from your existing clients and contacts
3. Covert your letter to a 2 or 3 column display ad – leverage existing marketing dollars
4. Create retail traffic with simple mailings
5. Create website traffic
6. Sell direct to consumers without any middlemen
7. Reduce refunds
8. Build anticipation for upcoming product launches
9. Find joint venture partners
10. Endorsed mailouts
11. Email campaigns that sell and educate
12. Web page sales copy
13. Product launches
14. Autoresponder sales campaigns
15. Phone script
16. Collect on outstanding bills
17. Get warm leads from “cold lists”
18. Fill seminars
19. Find distributors
20. Build an online database
21. Improve sales with eBay
22. Customer Appreciation events
23. Upsell your present customers on upgraded versions
24. Social Media updates extraordinaire! You’ve got enough ideas in here to keep your Facebook and Twitter feed busy for the next 365 days! Each of your posts can be sending traffic to your paid products or services – and they WILL make you sales when you are consistent!

*"Your last piece created over \$47,857 in revenues for us,
within the first 48 hours." - Joel Christopher*

WELCOME!

Let's get to 11 of the most important rules you need to stick to if you want to succeed in your marketing:

- . 1) **The purpose of your marketing is NOT to showcase your brand, your logo**, (it does not need to be for them to buy something, as it can be for them to take some kind of action like visiting a web page to get something for free)
- . 2) You **MUST** learn how to **create compelling offers that get them to take those actions**.
- . 3) **Each of the marketing campaigns you launch will consist of a minimum of 3 steps**. In other words, when communicating with your clients and prospects, you must send at least 3 different pieces to them in order to call it a properly designed campaign (and one that will actually work and help you achieve goal #1 from above)
- . 4) **No more cutesy sayings and vague one-liners** that say and do nothing that take you closer to goal #1. Again, a cute radio ad is useless if it doesn't generate you leads or make you money.
- . 5) You will **learn how to become a more natural writer**, and use those skills to further build on goal #1
- . 6) **Your personality in your marketing is your greatest asset**. Don't hide the fact that you are a real live person, like most business owners do. They try and mask the size of their company... pretending to be a big company. Putting your face and personality front and center in all your marketing will do more for your sales than anything else you do.
- . 7) Effective advertising **rarely looks like advertising**.
- . 8) **Effective advertising stops your ideal customer in their tracks** and literally forces them to start reading your ad.
- . 9) Effective advertising always has some form of **tracking mechanism in place** so you know exactly if it is working, or not. *My first few years into copywriting, I had logged 2,000 hours of writing and studying from the masters (I tracked my hours). Since discovering this thing called copywriting, I have a whole new world in front of me. I see why most businesses struggle. I see why people think marketing doesn't*

work. I see why most people think advertising is a waste of money. And I see why some companies go on and accomplish amazing things in record time. I have had the privilege to work with some incredible people, from all over the world. Movie stars. Bestselling authors. Public speakers. Inventors. Real estate investors and developers. Information publishers. All said and done, there are probably 35+ industries I have helped now. And have made them millions and millions of dollars in short periods of time.

Why do I share this with you? Because just 11 years ago I had no idea what marketing was or how it worked.

Today, I am an internationally-known entrepreneur who has helped thousands of people turn their businesses around.

Every week, my articles and blog posts go out to thousands of people spanning the globe. And I absolutely love seeing the look in a client's eye when they hit their first grand slam in marketing.

If I can do it, so can you. I failed English in high school and university. But I quickly discovered that real marketing doesn't care about proper grammar. As you will see in this chapter, real marketing breaks many of the rules of proper English.

Yet it works... and the results speak for themselves.

Looking forward to working with you. And I LOVE your comments... good and bad. Let me know what I can do to help you grow your business faster and more profitably.

Troy White "Turning Your Words Into Wealth" 403-259-4566

The Dale Carnegie Rules of Marketing Your Business Everyone knows Dale Carnegie...

A man whose legacy will live forever. A man who has changed millions of lives worldwide. And a man who has more of a grasp on the true art of marketing than many would ever recognize!

Having spent many hours there as a student and as a graduate assistant, I felt compelled to look back over his material and what I found astonished me.

If you want to market yourself or write effective copy - take heed in the following advice from Dale Carnegie himself. His book "How To Win Friends And Influence People" shares the following advice (*written in 1936 but as applicable today as back then*)...

*** **"First, arouse in the other person an eager want.** He who can do this has the whole world with him. He who cannot walks a lonely way" If they don't want what you sell - they won't buy it. You need to master the ability to showcase your product or service in a way that builds excitement and gets them passionate about buying what you offer.

*** **"Become genuinely interested in other people"** This actually should be first and foremost. If you don't understand who exactly your ideal buyers are... the rest of it is a waste of time.

But, when you dig deep into the profile of a buyer of your products, and you understand who they are, what average age they are, if they are married, single or divorced, if they have kids and what age, what books they read, movies they watch, and competitors they buy from... you won't be able to sell to them nearly as effectively as you could be.

FACE IT: the current economy has changed a lot of peoples buying preferences. They are holding off on purchases. They are making their decisions based on a new criteria, and they are definitely not buying like they used to. Do you know what the difference is with YOUR customers? You need to!

. *** **"Remember that a person's name is to that person the sweetest and most important sound in any language."** Always use YOU in the writing you do, and in the presentations you do for your clients.

One tip I give people in my classes is to take a sheet of paper and draw a line from top to bottom down the middle.

On the left side of the paper, count all the times you say "I", "me", "my", "us" or "our". On the right side of the paper, count all the times you say "you", "yours", "you'll", etc.

The references to "you" should outnumber the others by 8 to one MINIMUM. If you are talking about yourself that much, instead of talking about them, their needs, their problems they want solved, etc., you won't be getting nearly the response that you could! .

*** **"Become a good listener"** - potential clients don't want to hear about you and your company, they want you to listen to them, their problems, their dreams, their aspirations. Show them you understand this in your copy and they will listen then. .

*** **"Make the other person feel important"** - and do it sincerely- share with them how important they are now to you, to their friends, their family and the world

*** **"Get the other person saying yes, yes, yes immediately"**. What you don't want to do is get them started on a negative note answering things in their mind with the word NO. Show them how much you understand them, their problems, their deepest darkest desires for solving that problem.

Get them shaking their head yes, and leave them wondering how it is that you seem to know so much about them.

*** **"Make the other person happy to do what you suggest"**. If you can leave them with such an incredible feeling of self-satisfaction after they order... you have done your job right.

Better?

Give them an awesome story they could tell their friends, family, and loved ones that would leave them just as excited about the product they just ordered.

Get that across in your campaigns and you have done some amazing things that will show in your sales numbers!

Think about it – this advice is 75 YEARS OLD... and still is not being listened to by 90% of the small business owners out there.

Sad, but true.

If you could accomplish that in all your dealings with your clients - would you not be the leader in your field?

How many companies that you know of (and have bought from) actually apply even half of the above? 10%?

Make those your new mission in dealing with clients and see your profits soar this year - and your clients thank you beyond all belief for finally understanding their side of the equation!

To your success, Troy White

Your Cash Flow Calendar Creativity Connection

THE TOOL KIT

Let's start with getting some important tools together to start your path of idea generation. This kit contains tools that are critical to discovering your future profit powerhouse.

- **A NOTEBOOK!** Any kind will do. But, keep it personal and yours. A notebook will work fine but perhaps a funky journal from a bookstore is more your style. This notebook is now your best friend. It goes everywhere with you! It replaces your purse or your briefcase. It will end up holding the most powerful information inside of it. Something so simple can have so much power if it is used properly !
- **A PEN!** Not just any ordinary pen but a pen you are comfortable writing with and one that sparks you to want to write.
- **POST-IT NOTES!** If your notebook is not handy – you need to keep those ideas before you forget them. Keep yourself armed with post-it notes around you constantly.
- **DIFFERENT COLORED PENS, FELTS & CRAYONS!** When was the last time you wrote with a crayon? Try it again – you will be amazed at how such a simple tool can make your ideas flow much easier.
- **CONSTRUCTION PAPER OR A SCRAPBOOK!** Flipping through a magazine and something catches your eye? Use it. You never know when this idea might generate yours. Glue it to the paper or throw it into a scrapbook.

- **AN ALARM CLOCK!** This is so you don't focus on time during some of the exercises. Whenever time amounts are specified for activities or exercises, set your clock so you don't waste time worrying about the time.
- **DESIRE TO MAKE A CHANGE IN YOUR LIFE !** Perhaps the most important tool in your kit is desire. This one quality will take you to new heights and will guarantee you success in business and in life. Find it, keep it and nourish it – the power of desire can overcome almost anything !

NOTE: A very sad fact on the internet is that less than 20% of the people that purchase books on how to make money actually use the information. Please use the information here, come up with some ideas for your publishing business and get going – TODAY ! I do not want you to be one of the 80% that never use the information. So I am here to help – if at any point in this course you want clarification or help, please email me at troy@smallbusinesscopywriter.com

ASSESSING YOUR SITUATION

What things in your current life situation do you not like? If you could change one thing, what would it be? Chances are that you do have something you want to change about your life – otherwise you probably wouldn't be reading this. What if each one of us changed something in our life to improve it – or to make ourselves happier – wouldn't the world be a better place?

What are your reasons?

Money

Early Retirement

Time for hobbies

Time for family and friends

Time to read

Security for your future

Time to travel

Write down these reasons on a piece of paper or 3 x 5 cards and place it where you can see it at all times. It is your motivator. It is what is going to drive you to your success. Once you commit things to paper it seems to flip a switch inside of you and things start to happen. And not only write down the reasons but write down what each reason means to you – you want more money - why ? Maybe for a newer car, house, holidays ? Write them down and be specific with numbers or fixed dates to push you along.

(Eg – I will spend 15 hours per week more with my family. I will pay off all outstanding credit card debt within 60 days. I will have my start up business running within 60 days from now.)

Warm Ups

There are a number of phases you will have to go through to find your million dollar ideas, the first of which is the warm up. This consists of exercises designed to help you clear your mind and find the right state that you need to be in to begin your mental workout. These warm-up activities should become habitual daily activities. Everyday try to make the time to do these activities. If you can't seem to find the time for all activities at least try to incorporate one of these activities daily.

- **WRITE!** Write for the next 11 days, every day for 10-20 minutes in your notebook. Sit down and write about anything – even if it is something like “this exercise is dumb, my pen is not working right, my hand hurts, boy I wish it was the weekend then I can go do...” and so on. It doesn't matter what you write about, only that you write.

This helps clear your mind of all those daily things our mind gets trapped into. Try it and stick with it for at least the 11 days – I dare you! See what happens. Now this is a longer-term exercise that you need to keep up even if you find your great product idea right away. Writing will help keep your mind clear and focused. You might find that you never stop this.

This is an exercise that will change your life if you do it – please give it a chance ! There is an immense amount of insight within you waiting to come out and be heard. Your writing will help you find new product ideas and partnerships to follow, solutions to on-going issues you have, easy answers to questions and so on. The following exercises contain writing exercises so please start to write – like it or not ☺ If you want to succeed in life try this – guarantee it will bring you much closer than you are today.

- **FOCUS!** Write down a question or concern in your notebook. Set the alarm clock for 3 minutes. Close your eyes and concentrate on this for 3 minutes. The question can be anything such as:
 - a. What subject do I want to produce a guide on?
 - b. Where can I help others the most?
 - c. What skills do I have that are valuable to others?
 - d. What career path should I follow?
 - e. Why is the sky blue?
 - f. What type of business could I start and be successful in?
 - g. Where would my talents be of the most use to others?

Write down all those thoughts about that question in your notebook once finished. Don't do anything with it right now – just keep writing in your notebook.

- **DAYDREAM!** Go to your favourite place (a coffee shop, your bedroom). Do not take anything to read but do take your journal to write anything down that comes to mind. Just hang out and think for at least 10 - 20 minutes. Imagine what your life would be like if...Picture it, live it in your mind – how does it feel?

- **DRAW!** Use those crayons from your tool kit! Buy a colouring book if that helps or just draw, doodle, colour, write out your grocery list – anything. Just make sure you use your crayons.
- **LISTEN!** Music is very powerful – close your eyes while you are listening. Listen to your favourite song with the volume turned up (to help the brain's juices flow). Listen to some of your favourite music – and listen loud! If needed, use headphones to keep the neighbours at bay, but loud music can get those brain juices flowing. Then pick some music you never listen to – if you usually like rock and roll, listen to classical or jazz or country. Classical music has been proven time and time again to improve blood flow to the brain and greatly improve your thought process.
- **TIME!** Watch the alarm clock from your kit. Get comfortable and watch the second hand go around for 2 – 3 minutes. Try to quiet your mind by counting one-one thousand, two-one thousand, etc. Notice how slowly the second hand moves when you are in deep concentration. This is tough to do but is very helpful with focus. Practice this daily.
- **TOUCH!** Clasp your hand together in front of you with fingers interlocking. Notice which thumb is on top. Now re-clasp your hands with the other thumb on top. Focus on this task. This is a small exercise that shows how change can be difficult to accept at first but is much easier with practice.

BRAIN BOOSTER TIPS

- Eat foods containing barley and/or high concentrate carbohydrates – proven to build up memory and increase brain blood flow – critical for proper creativity and brainstorming attitudes.
- Get some exercise! I am not going to go into all the physiological benefits of exercise – you know it so just get out there and do it – go for a walk, run, power walk or even just sit around outside- that fresh air can do wonders. Start slow and build up to a good pace. When that blood gets flowing and your heart starts beating faster you will be amazed at the thoughts and ideas that start popping up in your mind.
- Get some relaxation or meditation music to sooth and clear your mind. With technology now it is easy to find this music and download it for free or next to free. Indulge in your favourite pastimes. Go walking, running; go to restaurants, cafes, coffee shops, pubs, the gym, play music, listen to music, paint, draw, sculpt, read, etc... The list can go on but it is up to you to write down everything that interests you.
- Use your lunch hours and after hours. Take your notebook with you to work – or, if it is too noticeable, go to the dollar store and buy a smaller notebook that will fit in your pocket. Always keep it with you to write down ideas and insights.
- Always keep thinking about this question “How can I _____?” This is where you need to go back to your list of things you want to have in your life.

I have a basic formula I use to create and evaluate new ideas. This is the exact formula I used to build a list of 300 ideas in no time at all.

This is what I recommend but I also think that some people have their own system they prefer – if it works – do it.

The 5 Step Profitable Idea Kit – EIDOP (sounds like eye drop)

Step 1 – Explore – Gather information about everything. The exercises you will find in here will help you analyze areas of your life that you should focus on for your information products. Lets say you decide you collect stamps as a hobby and you have decided to write an ebook on this subject. Start researching the market – online, offline, library, stores etc. Collect as much information as you can find. I would recommend listing off right away the exercises that you like the most – write down your answers to them immediately upon reading them. Then do the ones you don't like the sounds of – because they are probably the ones that will work the best for you !

Step 2 – Imagination – Generate a ton of ideas with the use of creativity and brainstorming techniques outlined here. Try and get your mind used to blurting out ideas without criticism. And keep on blurting until you can blurt no more. Do not pick any ideas – just keep writing them down

Step 3 – Devise – Select an idea through using your common sense, your research and further brainstorming and narrowing ideas here. Figure out which markets will pay for your information. Who are the experts in this field, what is lacking for information with this idea.

Step 4 – Optimize – Improve the idea by testing in the different means listed in the Marketing section. You need to test to find out what works best and what else you can change or add to your offering to make it 10 times better than anything else out there.

Step 5 – Perseverance – Never give up on your vision and your dream. There will be rough times – guaranteed! Show me something in life that does not have a bumpy path to achievement. But the key here is to keep testing different methods until you find some that work. And there is a million different tools available to you for free or inexpensive testing. Lots of them are listed in the resource guide at the end and there is many others I will be recommending to you over time via email.

So here you have a system that is proven, tested tried and true. Use it in your discovery and you will easily create 300 profitable ideas in 11 days. The key now thought is to get started with your discovery and do not look back. Remember, if there is ever anything you want clarification or help with to email me at troy@smallbusinesscopywriter.com or call me toll free at 403-259-4566.

STAYING FOCUSED

Staying focused on the project at hand can be hard. This is one of the biggest issues that I have always struggled with myself. I am an ideas-person so I always have way too many ideas floating around in my head. And that leads me to get on a tangent on one, two or three ideas at once, which in effect means I am not giving any one idea the focus it requires. So what can you do to stay focused on ideas and projects? Here are a few things that have worked for myself:

- **Get a day timer** – they cost as little as \$10.00 for a decent one – one that shows a week at a time with room on each day to write things down. This lets you plan a week out easily and see at quick glance what you need to get done.
- Turn those dreams and objectives into **to-do items and deadlines** to move forward. Put these dates in your day timer. Make sure that these are realistic though – do not tell yourself that you will write a book and have it published within 2 weeks if you have never done it before. Say it will take 6 months to write and publish. But you need to start writing – give yourself 2 weeks to have 20 pages – 1.5 pages a day. Break it down to smaller chunks to be more manageable and feasible.
- **Form a “Mastermind group”**. Napoleon Hill, author of the multi-million copy bestseller "Think & Grow Rich" emphasises that this is one of the most important steps that can be taken to achieving your dreams. This group ideally has 4 or more people (remember though that you can start with 2 people and build from there) that can help you with ideas to move you towards your dream life. And a variety of personalities and backgrounds can be good also so don't worry that people all have to be the same

or they won't get along. There is more electrical energy in the air when you have a group of unlike minds brainstorming rather than a group of like minds. Why? Because unlike minds see different aspects of the project and these differences when brought to light can bring up new ideas or creations. Start with one or two people and grow your group and quickly as you can manage it. Try to meet once a week or every other week if possible. So start thinking about people you know (or would like to know) that would be a good addition to your mastermind group. Approach them with the proposal and be prepared to some trade some ideas for their time. For example if one person is also looking to make a change in their life – offer to be a part of their mastermind group. Or if another person has a small company they run – offer to help with brainstorming new ideas for promotion for their company.

**** NOTE:** On the internet, you are going to hear of Joint Ventures and how they can make or break your publishing business. Joint Ventures are arrangements between 2 publishers to self promote each others products for profit and or recognition. The Master mind group you form at the start can be your eventual JV. If you all get together to discuss ideas and how to get them up and running quickly, you can all profit at the same time. So think about one person you know who wants to start their own business – call them and start talking about regular meetings. Do it ! But make sure right from the start you agree that you are getting together to help each other start their own business **not as a partnership** in the same business. Partnerships can be dangerous to a friendship so go it alone.

There is an absolute ton of things you can do to wake up your mind, jump start your inborn creativity and find out who is lurking inside your docile mind just waiting to jump out.

Read through each idea spark and note which ones you would like to start with. Then note which ones you do not want to do. Both will be helpful – the ones you agree with and the ones you disagree with.

As you go through this process you will find some things that work better for you. Notice which triggers work best for creativity and idea generation – maybe it is smells, sounds, water, walks etc. And write down any triggers that work especially well for you. Here is a quick list for you to keep in mind for idea triggers and creativity generating environments:

- While doing anything repetitive – painting, colouring, manual labour etc
- Listening in on a speech or sermon
- While out for a walk or run
- Intense exercise – aerobics, biking, martial arts etc
- While reading a novel
- Upon waking up in the middle of the night
- Driving in your car

- Relaxing
- While in a meeting
- Meditating
- Showering
- Note which other ones work great for you !

The key is that you have to do it. Stop thinking about it, stop talking about it, stop reading RIGHT NOW – and go do step one!

PLAYTIME PASSION - STEP ONE

Remember when you were a child? Remember the things that you enjoyed and that consumed your days and nights? Sometimes these things are easy to remember and other times a little reminder helps out.

The following list contains things you may have done when you were a child and may still do. Look through the list and make notes on which ones stand out for you – both for the good memories and the bad memories.

When you look through this list you will find that some things will make you feel different. Maybe you cannot put your finger on what feels different just something does. Listen up ! When your body tells you something like that please take note and write down which item made you feel that way – make a note that your stomach turned or your heart fluttered or you got gas and the cat passed out or.

Your past interests can be an amazing tool to find your true passions in life today. Unfortunately we tend to forget about the things that were so important to us in the past because we get wrapped up in our busy lives. Look at the list and remember what you can about **each** item. The ones that give you that feeling inside are the ones you want to pay attention to.

One of life's biggest disappointments is how quickly we encourage kids to grow up and act like an adult. How far has that advice gotten you ? Are you happier as an adult than you were as a kid ? Most of society would love to go back and enjoy the simple pleasures in life and get back some of that freedom we gave up as we got older.

Action Figures	Art classes	Airplanes	Archery	Board games	Basketball	Baking
Baton twirling	Blackboards and chalk	Beanbags	Biking	Binoculars	Bird watching	Blocks
Butterflies	Bowling	Cap guns	Cracker Jacks	Clay Creations	Caterpillars	Cots
Books	Boomerangs	Bubbles	Bug Collections	Boat sailing and building	Card games	Carpentry
Cards	Costumes	Chess	Candles	Camping	Checkers	Cats
Clay molding	Construction	Coloring books	Cartoons	Chalk boards and drawing	Cars	Cooking
Computer games	Crayons	Chemistry	Dancing	Dollhouses	Dogs	Dominoes

Reliving those kids live day is the	Dolls	Drumming	Dune buggy	Electric toys	Exercise	Elephants	Elegant party	some of joys that every one of simplest
	Dice	Dreams	Energy	Football	Firecrackers	Frisbee	Finger painting	
	Flower pressing	Finances	Forts	Guitar	Games	Gardens	Garages	
	Golf	Gymnastics	Hunting for bugs	Horseshoes	Haunting	Harmonica	Harp	
	Hammocks	Horoscopes	Helicopters	Hiking	Hockey	Jewelry making	Juggling	
	Jumping rope	Kaleidoscopes	Kites	Knitting	Letter writing	Listening to music	Lumber	
	Mummies	Magic tricks	Magnets	Microscope	Magnifying glass	Marbles	Marionettes	
	Model making	Musical instruments	Masks	Nature walks	Needle point	Paper airplanes	Paper mache	
	Plants	Pipes	Photography	Piano	Playgrounds	Ping pong	Poster coloring	
	Puppet making and play	Pool	Puzzles	Rocks	Remote control cars, boats planes	Reading	Robots	
	Slides	Skiing	Snow men	Star gazing	Scare Crows	Silk Screen	Soap Making	
	Ships	Sleds	Science	Scrap books	Scrap yards	Sand boxes	Rope	
	Skating	Stamp collecting	Skateboarding	Sketching	Tires – old tires and tubes	Twister	Trampoline	
	Tea Party	Tents	Trading cards	Telescopes	Swimming	Strings	Stickers	
	Train sets	Tools	Traveling	Violin	Volleyball	Video games	Walking	
	Whistling	Wagons	Whittling	Walkie Talkies	Writing	Xylophone	Wilderness	
	Yoga	Viewmaster	Yo-Yos	Yarn	Zebras	Zipper	Zoo trips	

exercises you can do to improve your life and the way you look at problems and issues. Bringing that zest for life into your own business will make your company stand out from the crowd and attract as much success as you dream for. Look at those people that took the plunge, started their own company, absolutely loved what they were doing and went on to make statements like “I never worked a day in my life since I became my own boss – it is too much fun to be work !”

There are many different ideas here waiting to happen.

If you have a hobby that is related to one of the above activities – you are on to something – write it down !

Information Ideas

101 ways to make money from your art

Secrets of baking success

Butterfly hot spots around the world

Training your old cat new tricks

Money making Kite Ideas

Mysterious Money from Magic

Travelling for dollars

How to travel the world on \$1,000

10 steps to Science success – Teaching your kid the basics

CREATIVITY EXERCISES:

- Go to the best candy store around and splurge on yourself – buy a Pez dispenser, liquorice, swizzlers – have fun – remember what it was like when you were a kid? What was your favourite thing to do as a kid ?
- If you could be a Superhero which one would you be? Or would you create your own? What is the outfit like? Special powers? Write it down.
- Listen to the questions that kids ask – they are experts at creativity and honesty. Watch them play and learn – they are masters of excitement, focus and imagination – try to copy some of their traits and use them in every day life.
- Buy some water based finger paints – get a friend or two together with some large sheets of brown paper – or a white table cloth – and have some fun – pretend you are 5 years old – what would you paint?!
- Pretend you are 2 or 3 years old – ask why to everything you see. Why is the sky blue? Why is it raining? Why ? Now ask these why questions about all businesses that you have been interested in the past. (Ex. Why do coffee shops all have a similar set-up ? Why don't coffee shops have more music ? Or more social activities ?)
- Do something totally out of character – with friends or with strangers – it doesn't matter.

Product Promo Tip

If you have an existing company and are looking for new ways to promote or advertise – pay attention to the above list ! There is over 160 different ideas there that may help. Think about it – you are looking for ideas for your custom gift baskets and you start looking through this list for ideas. Maybe have art classes for free where people can decorate their own gift baskets. Or maybe you start doing gift baskets for kids birthdays – consisting of toy trains, bubble machines and books. Or what about bug collecting gift baskets with nets and jars and magnifying glasses etc. Or a friend is going away on a trip somewhere you could build gift baskets for the travelers with film for their camera, first aid kits, waterproof pouches, money belts etc. There are lots of ideas out there if you put your mind to it and try some new things. If you look around at society and small business – the problem as a whole is that everyone expects wonderful things to happen in their personal and business lives but they never do anything to get there. Back to the saying – “if you keep doing the same things day after day you can not expect the results to be any different“

CREATIVITY EXERCISES

- Go to the zoo. Watch children's faces as they light up with delight when seeing a tiger for the first time. Or think about the animals. Just what are they thinking ? What about animals do you enjoy the most (companionship, safety, comfort etc) ?

- Go for a walk anywhere, new or old. Try and get into the habit of walking once a day or once every other day. Walking is one of the most powerful idea generation techniques out there – so bring your notebook !
- Ask yourself – “What would I do if there was a cash reward of \$100,000 for solving this problem within the next 2 days?” “Or what if there was a cash reward of \$100,000 to you if you come up with a creative business concept in the next 2 days ?”
- Invent something – look in your junk drawers – find a couple items that stand out – find a way to make them work with each other or work in a new way or for a new use.
- Rent your favourite funniest movies and laugh, laugh, laugh!
- Close your eyes and imagine yourself being able to actually massage your stress points in your mind. When you first close your eyes, concentrate on your breathing – feel the breath go in and go out. Concentrate on this until you feel some of the tension come out. Feel the tense spots and pressure points? Lightly mentally massage out the tension – feel the difference it can make.
- Create a collage – get out some construction paper, scissors and tape or glue. Find some old magazines and newspapers and start cutting out headlines and pictures that sum up your goals, motivations, dreams and aspirations. Find a headline that really stands out to you as a statement and put it right in the centre of your collage. Try this ! It is fun getting dirty and being a little crazy with some scissors and glue ☺ Here is an idea with this “Cash from your Collages”. Sound crazy ? Have you been to a scrap booking store lately ? They are popping up everywhere and they are selling products like hot cakes !

***“Reflection is one of the most underused yet powerful tools for
success.” -- Richard Carlson***

- Go to your local dollar store– take \$10 with you and buy some Hot Wheels or Barbies or other toys that you used to play with when you were a kid. What information is needed by people that collect these ? Look at all the Beanie Baby collectors guides out there now – somebody is making some serious money !
- Go back to the basics. Read about famous people from the past and how they became famous – Einstein, Edison, Mozart, Davinci etc. They all have amazing stories and each of us could learn immensely from them. How does what they went through apply to your life? Could you change things like they did? One of the best authors writing about these techniques is *Michael J Gelb* who recently wrote *Discover your Genius*.
- If you are not a puzzle or crossword person – start working on them in the paper – or if you are a crossword person – try brain twister exercises.
- Get a dictionary or thesaurus out – close your eyes and put your finger on a word on any page – look at the word and think/write down how it applies to your problem or project –compare and contrast. (eg – I picked **far** out of the dictionary – I think about it and I think – I am far away from a beach but if I keep working hard on my problem I will be on a beach in 2 months on a 2 week holiday. Also if I look back in time I have come a far ways from where I was 2 years ago for happiness and fulfillment). ***Product Idea – Far Away Fortunes – Stories of Success from Overseas***
- With the same thesaurus, sit down and pick out 10 words out of the thesaurus that describe you. Write them down and then expand on why you think those words describe you. Write down everything you want. Do not hold back or feel guilty about

wanting things. Write down everything you want in love, relationships, business, spiritual, financial, recreational, personal growth, material goods. Remember that this is helpful to cleanse yourself and get these wants down on paper. Write down the little secrets that you have always dreamed of.

- Find a place with a fireplace and hang out with a coffee, drink and think. Write down what you enjoy about coffee houses or what you don't like about them.
- Try a new sports activity – roller blade, ski, run, walk, lift weights, try martial arts etc – most have trials at no cost – good way to see what else is out there. What is hard to find ? Information for the beginner on ?

**** Product Idea – How you too can make \$100k/year in the sports industry. Interview successful sales and marketing people in the sports business and find out what makes them so successful. ****

- Have a show and tell party with your friends and/or your mastermind group. Remember these from school ? Time to show off your prize possessions or ideas. Plan ahead with your group and each person gets 5 minutes to show off what they are passionate about.
- Go to a pet store and look around. Picture things from a fish's perspective, or a cat's perspective or a dog's, etc. What would they like to see, smell, taste ?
- Learn the art of Mind Mapping (there is some great books out there – notably by *Tony Buzan* who termed this process Mind Mapping) as it can help you generate tons of good ideas as well as helps you focus on your to-do lists and find quick ways to get things done. This is a subject that deserves a entire book in itself to educate yourself on. For now I will provide you with a simple example which you can experiment with. The best process to use is:
 1. Start in the centre with your problem or goal
 2. Every idea that comes to you based on the problem – write it down around your center question – just start thinking of everything related to your problem or question
 3. Start looking at all of the ideas and do the same for each one. . Work on the free thought process for 2-5 minutes and see what you come up with.
 4. Use different colours, arrow types, drawings, text type etc. The point is to get your mind flowing and working on all kinds of different ideas and associations. When you are completed the free thought flow look at what you have put down and see what words relate to each other or compliment each other and connect them with new lines.
 5. Look at the entire mind map you have drawn and try to pick out the top 3-5 main points or concepts that came up.
 6. Try this again with the 3-5 main points. Lets say based on the following map (which should be expanded upon before completion) that you choose a kids furniture business and a home delivery business as a couple main points. Put these as your central points on a new map and start over.
- Go to a museum – one of the most under utilized tools for relaxation, idea generation and creativity building. Take your notebook and write down what catches your eye or interest.

- “I wish it was easier to get _____? This sentence can help you find a number of ideal businesses for yourself. Number one, it tells you something about your interests and passions; you are the one that finds an issue with it. And if you have a problem with it chances are that there are thousands of people out there with the same problem.
- Ask yourself one of those important questions – then open up a magazine or book that catches your eye. Randomly pick a page and then read the first sentence that stands out to you. How does it relate to your search?
- Stop reading – anything! -for a few days. If you are like me this is tough to do – I love to read! But I also found that this helps clear your mind and refocuses you on your goal – to live your dream life!
- Be silly for a day about anything and everything.
- Get a drastic haircut or colour – it grows back and it can be coloured back.
- Wear something incredibly tacky or something you would not usually wear. Whenever I am in need of some new ideas I throw on my ugliest Hawaiian shirts (this one almost makes you blind) and a funny thing happens – my mind starts whirling.

EXCELLENT BRAINSTORMING TECHNIQUE

Get yourself some post it notes, some pens, some large blank sheets of construction paper or use a 8 x 11 sheet of paper.

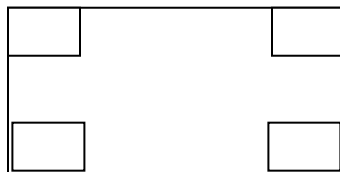
Step 1 - Write down on a post it your goal for brainstorming (eg – an idea for a part time business I can start). Put this post it in the centre of the table.

Step 2 - Now start writing (one idea per post it) the first things that come to mind (eg – helping elders, writing a book, coffee delivery, home parties, etc – keep going until you run out of ideas. Have these all spread out around your main question from step 1

Step 3 – Have numbers written on each post it with an idea 1, 2, 3, up to as many ideas as you have. Now do the same with small slips of paper so there is as many as there is ideas. So you have 14 ideas and 14 slips of paper with the numbers written on them.

Step 4 – Put the slips of paper in a hat or box or cup – whatever works for you – pick out 4 slips. Now pick each idea whose corresponds with the slip of paper (so you picked number 7 and idea # 7 was photo scrap booking sales as an example).

Step 5 – Put each of the 4 ideas on the corners of the construction paper or other paper you are using – they key is to have an idea on each corner and blank space in the middle.



Step 6 – Look at each of the 4 pieces of paper on the corners and write down the first things that come to mind on the blank space in the middle.

Step 7 – with a new pen colour start brainstorming combinations of the 4 ideas and write the combinations in the centre of the paper.

Also factor in the items you listed when you first looked at the 4 main ideas. Lets say we had the following 4 ideas on the corners:

Photo Scrap Booking

Pet day care and walking service

Selling health products door to door

Custom sign design and printing

Now we start brainstorming and we get some of the following (some far out) ideas

Pet Scrap booking

Holistic products for pets

Pet memorials

Signs built for pet owners

Signs with picture collages as the focus

Selling picture collages as celebrations or pets lives

Lawn signs with pets as characters – birthdays, anniversaries etc

How to guide on being healthy and wealthy with a holistic pet business

Specialty pet gift baskets

Pet product of the month club

Step 8 – now you have a list of off the wall business ideas. What I like to do is pick 4 more slips out and put 4 more ideas on the corners (overtop of the previous 4) and do this again with the new ideas but use the same paper with the business ideas generated from above.

So add to this list again.

Step 9 – Now you may be running out of ideas or you can keep going to build your list. At this point you can also start combining the business ideas from step 7 and 8 into new and improved business ideas. For an example – “Pet product of the month club sold as a gift basket arrangement for pet birthdays”.

Step 10 – Walk away for an hour or two ! That’s right, forget about this and go do something else and let you subconscious mind do some work on this.

Step 11 – Go back to your list of business ideas. What does your stomach or heart tell you to do ? Listen to yourself here ! Your subconscious will have figured out which ideas have the most potential for yourself and now listen to your internal voice to tell you which ones are best.

Remember that there is no such thing as bad ideas – only ideas with potential ! Everything requires some work in this world – try and make it fun work though – only go after the things that bring fun or joy into your life. Each one of my crazy ideas listed has potential as an information product. Don't believe me ?

MEDIA CHECKLIST

Please find below a checklist for getting you recognized by the media when you send out a press release:

Part 1 - Getting the release ready.

- € Download the fill-in-the-blank press release expressly created for this program.
- € Fill in the release with your information anywhere you see highlighted areas. Be sure to remove all the highlighted areas, as well as the credit information, after you are finished!

Part 2 - Who to send it to (local).

- € Focus on local, first.
- € Other ways to find the right reporter and right publication.
 - You can also find great contacts by using the newspapers, magazines, etc., you may already have. Simply look for reporters who are covering your press release topic and take down their contact details.
 - You can also use online directories to search for other outlets. A great one is http://dir.yahoo.com/News_and_Media/
 - Let your fingers do the walking by using the phonebook to find other media outlets
- € Call to confirm all contacts. Ask how they want to get your release: email, fax, snail-mail.
- € Send out release to each reporter as they prefer.

Part 3 - Who to send it to (national).

- € Research media outlets online which appeal to your target market. Use the same system outlined above to find out the right contacts.
- € Use release posting websites. These are great for search engine optimization, and driving others to your website. But please remember, they often don't lead to any media coverage.
 - Here's a list of sites to post:
 - www.prleap.com
 - www.prweb.com
 - www.addpr.com
 - www.express-press-release.com
 - www.free-press-release.com
 - www.openpr.com
 - www.press-base.com
 - www.press411.com
 - www.pressreleasespider.com
 - www.i-newswire.com
 - A note on PR Web. I highly recommend this one. Although you will have to pay for the service, if you really want to make a splash to increase your search engine rankings, this is the one!

Part 4 - Following up with reporters.

- € Choose which media outlets are important to you - the places you really want the release to appear in.
- € Call and ask for the reporter.
- € First, introduce yourself and ask if they have time to talk.
 - If yes, then go to next step
 - If no, then find out when would be a good time to call back. (Then do so!)

- € Do **NOT** tell the reporter you are following up on a press release. Instead say:

I have some additional information that I left out of the release I sent you about... (fill in with topic)

At this point the reporter will say to continue or that they don't recall the release.

If it's to continue, say the following:

Did you know that (add additional info here). Do you think this would make an interesting local story?

Or say:

Since announcing I am doing XX, many people, especially others in my field, asking me how I XX. I think it's something that your readers would be interested in, too. Do you agree?

If the reporter says he or she did not getting the release:

Offer to resend it. Confirm the reporter's method of receipt. And ask when you can call back to make sure they got it. (Then follow up by using the method above.)

- € If the reporter says, "No Thanks. I don't think I'm interested."
 - Ask the reporter why.
 - * It may often be the case that you targeted the wrong reporter! In this case, ask them for the correct contact and report the whole process by sending the correct contact the release.
 - * If he or she truly isn't interested, ask what he or she is interested in covering. If you can fill one of the reporter's topics, tell him or her so immediately.
 - Thank the reporter for his or her time and ask they would be interested in other stories from you in the future. (Make a note for future reference!)
- € If the reporter says, "Yes."
 - Find out if the reporter will be running the release as is or wants to set up an interview.
 - Thank the reporter for his or her time.

Part 5 - The interview

- € When a reporter wants to interview you:
 - DON'T just answer off the cuff. Ask for a time to call them back if they are doing a phone interview.
 - Confirm the topic and focus of what the interview is going to be about.
 - Set up a time for the interview.
- € Use the interview prep worksheet to prepare your talking points. (download)
- € If your interview is face-to-face with camera use:
 - Don't wear all black. You'll look as though you're disappearing into a hole. This often throws women into a panic, as we love the slimming properties of black, particularly when TV will probably make you look slightly heavier than you are in real life.
 - Don't wear all white. It makes the lights that may be used bounce back and you'll look as though you just descended from the heavens on a cloud.
 - Don't wear anything with a very small pattern such as pin-stripes, tweed or polka dots. Again, it has a strange effect on lights known as strobing.
 - No visible logos of companies or brands (watch out for this particularly on sportswear) as this may be regarded as advertising. You may be asked to change if a logo is too obvious.
 - Avoid buying a new outfit the day before and acting as if you're going to a job interview. If you feel too stiff and formal in your clothes this will affect how you express yourself.
 - You should wear your make-up much heavier than you normally would. Otherwise you will look washed out.
- € Some things to remember, during the interview:
 - Focus on your three main points from your worksheet.

- If a reporter is quiet, that doesn't mean fill in the space with you talking. It's a tactic for you to reveal too much.
- Nothing is EVER 'off the record.'
- If you don't know, say so. And offer to find out the information.
- If, for any reason, you can't reveal something, explain that as honestly as you can.

Part 6 - Leveraging your publicity.

- € Post any coverage you receive onto your website. Check to make sure you can use the footage or story, as copyright may apply. If you cannot post the whole thing, perhaps you create a link to their website.
- € Post "As Seen On" on main page of site with a list of the media outlets you've been featured on/in.
- € Send an announcement to your customers/clients
- € Send announcement to possible clients/customers
- € Use Google News Alerts to help track coverage as well.

Part 7 - Getting more publicity.

- € Send reporters a hand written thank you note no more than three days after your story appeared.
 - Express gratitude for taking the time out of their schedule.
 - Tell them what the coverage meant to others (It was informative, well written, etc.)
 - Do NOT thank them for the coverage or tell them how the coverage benefited you.
 - Tell them you will check back with other ideas every month or so that may be of interest to them

Credit: This press release template is given exclusively to Troy White's Marketing and Promotional Calendar recipients by Shannon Cherry.

Shannon Cherry, APR, MA is The Power Publicist. The founder of Be Heard Solutions (www.beheardsolutions.com) , she helps small business owners and entrepreneurs to attract targeted prospects by using the power of publicity and promotions. Sign up for her free Publicity Power Pack, which gives you access to free publicity and marketing tips, media contacts and more at <http://www.beheardsolutions.com>

We would love to hear from you...if you have a campaign that you did and want it featured in the Calendar – please send us your campaign along with your credentials and we will include it in our next publication.

We can be reached troy@smallbusinesscopywriter.com

All the best, Troy White
www.cashflowcalendars.com